

SchoolSteps

Run it. Track it. Report it. — All in one place.

The complete school management system for Pakistani schools — attendance, tests, report cards, parent communication, timetables, and more.

Product Requirements Document — v1.0

October 2026

Working name "SchoolSteps" proposed (brand family with HomeSteps).
Prepared from the founder's vision — pilot school ready.

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1. Vision & Problem

The problem

Pakistani schools run on registers, paper files, and WhatsApp chaos. Teachers mark attendance in notebooks. Test marks live in diaries. Month-end report cards take days of manual work. Parents hear about problems weeks late — or never. PTM dates get lost in group chats. The school has no single system.

The vision

SchoolSteps is one web app where the whole school runs: the teacher taps attendance and the parent instantly gets a message; test marks go in and month-end report cards come out automatically; PTMs get scheduled with reminders; every parent message, call, and review lives in one place. *Pora system.*

> **North-star metric:** a school that runs its full month — attendance, tests, reports, parent comms — inside SchoolSteps with zero paper.

White-label principle

Every school sees its OWN brand. The app shows each school's name, logo, and colors everywhere (dashboards, report cards, messages). The product name ("SchoolSteps" — working title, not final) stays in the background. This is the #1 selling point when pitching to other schools: *"ye aapke school ka apna system lagega."*

2. User Roles

Role	Who	What they do
Admin	School owner / principal	Manages everything: students, teachers, classes, syllabus, timetables, fees view, all reports
Teacher	Class teachers	Marks attendance, enters test marks, views own timetable, messages parents of own class
Parent	Mothers / fathers	Receives attendance alerts, monthly reports, PTM invites; views child's progress; gives reviews

Login via email + password (Firebase Auth — same as HomeSteps). Each role sees a different dashboard.

3. Modules (M1–M9)

M1 — Student & Parent Database

The single source of truth for every child and their family.

- Student profile: name, class, section, roll number, date of birth, photo (optional)
- **Parent data:** father + mother names, phone numbers (WhatsApp), address, emergency contact
- Admission date, status (active / graduated / left)
- Search & filter by class, section, name
- Import from Excel for bulk admission at session start

M2 — Smart Attendance + Parent Notifications

"Bache aaye, teacher ne attendance add ki, parents ko msg gaya."

- Teacher opens today's class list, taps Present / Absent / Late per child (big touch-friendly buttons)
- **On submit → automatic WhatsApp message to each parent:** "Assalam-o-Alaikum! Ahmed (Class 3) is marked **Present** today. — [School Name]"
- Absent alert: "Ahmed is marked **Absent** today. Please inform the class teacher if this is unexpected."
- Daily attendance % per class on admin dashboard; monthly attendance summary per child
- Late arrivals logged with time

Why it matters: parents' #1 anxiety is "did my child reach school safely?" This one feature alone sells the system.

M3 — Tests, Exams & Auto Report Cards

"Monthly tests daale, month ke end me report tayyar mil jaye — mid-year aur final ka bhi."

- Teacher enters marks per subject per test (monthly test / mid-year exam / final exam)
- Grading schemes configurable: marks, grades (A+/A/B…), or both; pass % per school
- **One tap → report card generated** with school branding (logo, colors, principal signature line)
- Report card shows: subject marks, total, %, grade, position in class, teacher remarks, attendance %
- Term comparison: monthly → mid-year → final progress graph per child
- Printable A4 + PDF download

M4 — Monthly Result Auto-Delivery

- At month end, admin triggers (or schedules) result dispatch
- Each parent automatically receives their child's report card via **WhatsApp** (PDF) + in-app notification
- Delivery log: who received, who is pending, resend button
- Parents can also view all past report cards in their dashboard anytime

M5 — PTM Scheduler

"PTM ki date bhi adjust kre."

- Admin creates PTM event: date, time slots, classes included, venue/note
- Automatic WhatsApp invite to all parents with their slot
- Reminder message 1 day before + morning of PTM
- Reschedule support: change date → all parents auto-notified
- RSVP tracking: parent confirms attendance (Yes / No) from the message link

M6 — Communication Hub

"Calls bhi le, msg bhi kre."

- **Broadcast messages:** admin/teacher sends announcement to a class, section, or whole school via WhatsApp
- **1-to-1 parent chat:** teacher ↔ parent messaging inside the app (logged, no personal numbers exposed)
- **Call logs:** log parent calls with date, reason, outcome — full history per family
- Message templates: fee reminder, holiday notice, urgent alert, PTM invite (one-tap send)
- Full history per child: every message, call, and notice in one timeline

M7 — Reviews & Feedback

"Reviews bhi le."

- After PTM / term end, parents receive a short feedback form (star rating + comment)
- Admin dashboard: average rating, per-teacher feedback, trend over terms
- Public testimonial mode: with parent permission, showcase best reviews on school profile
- Complaint box: parents can raise concerns privately → admin assigns → resolved status tracked

M8 — Syllabus Manager (per class, branded)

- Per class: subjects list, monthly syllabus breakdown, book names
- Branded syllabus PDFs with **school logo + colors** (like HomeSteps worksheets)
- Share syllabus to parents via WhatsApp at term start
- Progress tracking: teacher ticks completed topics → syllabus completion % per class

M9 — Teacher Timetables & Period Schedule

- Weekly period grid per teacher and per class (Mon–Sat, periods 1–8)
- Auto-conflict detection: same teacher in two classes at once → warning
- Substitution helper: teacher absent → find free teacher for that period
- Printable timetable with school branding; teacher dashboard shows "my today"

4. A Day in the Life

🌅 Teacher (7:45 AM)

```
Opens SchoolSteps → taps attendance for Class 3 (28 present, 2 absent)
→ parents auto-notified on WhatsApp
→ teaches periods per "My Today" timetable
→ enters yesterday's Urdu test marks (5 min)
```

🏫 Admin / Principal (5 PM)

```
Dashboard: today's attendance 96%, 2 fee reminders pending
→ taps "Send" → WhatsApp reminders go out
→ reviews monthly reports ready for dispatch → schedules Friday delivery
→ creates PTM event for next Saturday → invites auto-sent
```

🌙 Parent (8 PM)

```
WhatsApp: "Ahmed's October report card is ready 📄" → taps → PDF opens
→ sees marks, grade, teacher remark → replies "Thank you!" → leaves 5-star
review
```

5. Technical Architecture

- **Frontend:** responsive web app (mobile-first — teachers use phones), same stack as HomeSteps (HTML/CSS/JS)
- **Auth:** Firebase Authentication (email/password, role-based: admin / teacher / parent)
- **Database:** Cloud Firestore (real-time; multi-user — unlike HomeSteps' localStorage, this needs true cloud from day one)

- **Messaging:** Phase 1 — WhatsApp via wa.me deep links + templates (free, manual-ish). Phase 2 — WhatsApp Business Cloud API for fully automatic sends (Meta, free tier generous)
- **Reports:** client-side PDF generation (print CSS), branded templates
- **Hosting:** GitHub Pages (free) or Firebase Hosting; custom domain when ready
- **Why not localStorage:** multiple teachers + parents must see the SAME live data → cloud database is mandatory

6. Pricing (PKR)

Plan	Price	For
Pilot	Rs 0 (3 months)	Our own school — prove it works, collect testimonials
Small school	Rs 2,500 / month	Up to 200 students, 2 admin accounts
Standard	Rs 5,000 / month	Up to 600 students, unlimited teachers, WhatsApp automation
Annual	2 months free	Any plan, paid yearly

One paying school at Standard = Rs 5,000/mo. Ten schools = Rs 50,000/mo. Pakistani private schools number in the tens of thousands — even a tiny slice is a real business.

7. Pilot Plan — Our School First

> **Month 1:** Build M1 (database) + M2 (attendance + parent WhatsApp). Import real students. Teachers use it daily.

> **Month 2:** Add M3 (test marks → report cards) in time for the next monthly test cycle. Deliver first auto report cards.

> **Month 3:** Add M5 (PTM) + M6 (comms). Run one full month 100% inside SchoolSteps, zero paper.

Success criteria: teachers prefer it over registers; parents reply to attendance messages; principal refuses to go back. Collect video testimonials.

8. Roadmap & Phases

Phase 1 — Pilot core (months 1–3): M1, M2, M3 — database, attendance, tests & report cards. Our school live. **Login phasing:** pilot starts WITHOUT login (founder + 1 teacher testing, no real data). **Firebase login (admin/teacher/parent roles) goes live BEFORE any real student/parent data is entered** — children's data must never sit behind open access. Reuse the HomeSteps Firebase login code.

Phase 2 — Parent loop (months 4–5): M4, M5, M6 — auto-delivery, PTM, communication hub. First paying schools.

Phase 3 — Depth (months 6–8): M7, M8, M9 — reviews, syllabus manager, timetables. Fee tracking module.

Phase 4 — Scale (month 9+): multi-branch support, owner analytics across schools, Play Store app.

Founder rule: do NOT build Phase 2 until Phase 1 is live in the pilot school and teachers love it. No exceptions.

9. Assumptions & Open Questions

#	Assumption / Question	Status
1	Working name "SchoolSteps" — confirm or rename	OPEN
2	School name, classes, student count for pilot branding	OPEN — needed before M1
3	App language: full English UI like HomeSteps? (Urdu optional later)	ASSUMED English
4	WhatsApp automation: Phase 1 manual wa.me links acceptable?	ASSUMED yes
5	Who enters data initially — admin imports Excel, or teachers add?	OPEN
6	Fee tracking module — in scope for Phase 3?	OPEN

End of PRD v1.0 — prepared October 2026 from the founder's vision. Next step: answer open questions, then build Phase 1 pilot.